# Agreement Portal — User Manual

Oct 24, 2026 · @Kalyan

## Before you start

**The portal is at https://bcagreement.gramtarang.org**

Sign in with the account an administrator issued you. Sessions last 30 minutes and then ask you to sign in again.

Two things on first use are expected, not faults. Your browser will warn that the certificate is not trusted — that is the placeholder certificate on this proof of concept, and you can continue past it. If the site does not load at all, your machine cannot resolve the address; ask IT for an internal DNS entry.

This manual covers the two roles that do most of the work. **Administrators** set the system up; **agents** create and sign agreements. The two GTIDS signers have a short section of their own at the end, because their part is a single button.

| You are | You need | Your section |
|---|---|---|
| An administrator | Each bank's agreement document, and the e-Stamp certificates | Administrator manual |
| An agent at a bank | Nothing to upload — your bank's agreement is already in the system | Agent manual |
| The GTIDS employee, or the MD | Nothing. You are told when it is your turn | Signing for GTIDS |

## Who does what

Agents belong to banks. Each bank has its own agreement text and its own GTIDS countersigner, both set by an administrator. An agent at Union Bank executes Union Bank's agreement and cannot substitute anything else.

An agreement passes through four hands, in a fixed order:

1. **An administrator** sets the bank up — its agreement document, and which GTIDS employee countersigns for it — and registers the e-Stamp papers.
2. **The agent** creates the agreement, allocates a stamp paper, composes the document and signs first.

3. **The GTIDS employee** reviews and countersigns.
4. **The Managing Director** signs last, which completes the agreement.

The order cannot be varied. Each signing button simply does not appear until the previous signature exists — not as a reminder, but because the system has no route from an unsigned agreement to a later one. Asking the server directly is refused for the same reason.

Two things an agent cannot do, by design. They cannot choose **which document** is executed, because the text belongs to the bank; and they cannot choose **who countersigns**, because nominating your own reviewer would defeat the point of the review.

One stamp paper serves exactly one agreement. Once claimed it leaves inventory, and a second attempt to register the same certificate is rejected whichever of its three identifiers is reused.

Being an administrator does not let you sign. Administration covers banks, users and stamps; signing belongs to the agent, the employee and the MD, and someone who must do both needs both roles.

# Administrator manual

Three jobs: set each bank up, create the agents, and keep stamp paper in inventory.

## 1 — Set up a bank

Go to **Banks** under Administration. A bank needs three things, and the page tells you which are missing.

1. Press **Add bank**. Give it a short code for your own use ( `UBI` ) and the full name ( `Union Bank of India` ). The code does not appear in agreement numbers.
2. Find the bank in the list and press **Finish setup**.
3. Choose the **GTIDS employee who countersigns** for this bank, and save. Only internal staff holding the Employee role are listed — an agent cannot be chosen, because both signatures would then sit on the same side of the agreement.
4. Upload **this bank's agreement document**: PDF or Word, up to 12 MB.

A banner at the top names every bank that is not yet usable. Finish them before telling agents to start: an agent at an unfinished bank cannot create an agreement, and will have the stamp paper in hand by the time they find out.

**Check the page count the upload reports back.** A Word file that converts to one page when it should be four is the failure worth catching here, while re-exporting is still cheap. Open the document and look at it before any agreement is executed from it.

Uploading again creates a new version and makes it active. Every agent at that bank then executes the new text. The previous version is kept, because agreements already executed were executed from it.

## 2 — Create the agents

Go to **Users** under Administration.

1. Enter the **Email** and **Full name**.
2. Under **What is this person?** choose *An agent at a bank*, or *GTIDS staff*.
3. For an agent, pick **Which bank?**. For staff, tick the roles they need.
4. Leave the password blank to have one generated, and press **Save account**.

**The password is shown once.** Copy it before leaving the page, give it to them directly rather than by email alongside their username, and have them change it. If it is lost, use **Reset password** — there is no way to retrieve it.

An agent belongs to one bank and holds no GTIDS role; GTIDS staff belong to no bank. The form follows this, and the server refuses the combinations that break it: an agent holding a GTIDS role would put both signatures on the same side of the agreement.

Entering an email that already exists updates that account and **replaces** its roles, rather than creating a second one. Its password is left alone unless you set one, so adding a role cannot lock someone out.

Three deactivations are refused: the last administrator, your own account, and a bank's designated countersigner — that last one would make every agreement at those banks fail at creation.

## 3 — Register stamp papers

Go to **Stamp inventory** → *Register a stamp paper*.

1. Under **Scan of the stamp paper**, choose the file and press **Read the scan**. Nothing is saved yet.
2. Read the notice at the top of the confirmation panel. **Green** means the values came from the document's own text and are exact. **Amber** means they were read by OCR and every one is a guess.
3. Check the three **Identifiers** against the paper in front of you, and correct anything wrong.

4. Check **Denomination** says 100, not 0. The certificate also prints a *Consideration price*, usually zero, which is a different number.
5. Press **Confirm and register**.

**Upload the issuer's PDF rather than a scan whenever you have it.** It carries real text, so the certificate number and the SUBIN reference are read exactly. A scan goes through OCR, which guesses at characters and confuses O with 0 and I with 1 — on precisely the numbers that identify the instrument.

| Field | On an Andhra Pradesh certificate | Where to look |
|---|---|---|
| Certificate number | `IN-AP77702625151064Y` | Top block, after *Certificate No.* |
| Unique document reference | `SUBIN-APAP181683033677125780403 9Y` | After *Unique Doc. Reference*. This is what the issuer's own portal verifies against. |
| Pre-printed paper serial | `FH 0001752181` | Usually bottom right, printed on the paper rather than generated |

Punctuation, spacing and case are ignored when checking for duplicates, so `IN-AP777…` and `inap777…` count as the same stamp.

**Account reference** is deliberately not an identifier. It names the vendor's account and repeats across every stamp they issue, so checking it for duplicates would reject legitimate stamps.

If a value looks wrong and you want to see what was actually read, open **Show the raw text that was read** at the bottom. That is the text the portal worked from, and it is the fastest way to tell a misread from a missing field.

On success the portal confirms the scan was hashed on upload. That hash is what makes later alteration of the stored scan detectable.

## Agent manual

You do not upload an agreement. Your bank's agreement is already in the system, and every agent at your bank executes the same text. Your part is the stamp paper, the particulars, and your signature.

### 1 — Create the draft

Go to **Agreements → New agreement**.

1. Choose the **Type**.
2. Set **State of execution** — it should match the state that issued the stamp paper. For an Andhra Pradesh stamp that is `IN-AP`.
3. Fill the **Agreement particulars**. These are not printed into the agreement; they make the register searchable and drive reporting, so they are optional but worth completing.
4. Enter the **Agent** and **Managing Director** names and emails. You will not be asked for the GTIDS employee — that is set per bank by an administrator.
5. Press **Create draft agreement**.

The agreement now has a number in the form `GTIDS/2026-27/SVCAGR/000025` and sits in **Draft**. Nothing is composed or signed yet, and you can still edit the particulars.

If you are told **no GTIDS employee signer is designated** for your bank, or that no agreement document is active, stop and tell an administrator which bank it is. Nothing you can do on this screen will fix it.

## 2 — Allocate the stamp paper, then compose

You are now on the agreement's own page, where everything else happens. Order matters.

1. In **Allocate stamp paper**, choose one from **Available stamps** and allocate it. Only papers an administrator has registered, and that no other agreement has claimed, appear here.
2. In **Prepare the agreement**, press **Compose the agreement**.

There is no file to choose, and that is deliberate: the text is your bank's. Composing puts the stamp scan as page 1 with the agreement on the pages after it.

The compose button stays disabled until a stamp is allocated, because the stamp becomes page 1 of what gets signed.

**Read the composed document before you sign.** If the text is wrong for this engagement, stop and tell an administrator — it cannot be changed once any signature is applied, and starting again means a fresh stamp paper.

## 3 — Sign

In **Your actions**, press **Sign as Agent**, then **Continue to eSign provider**. You authenticate there with an Aadhaar OTP. Return to the portal and refresh.

GTIDS never sees your Aadhaar number or the OTP. Only the document's digest is sent to the provider.

The agreement then moves to **Awaiting GTIDS signature**. Nothing further is needed from you; you will receive the executed document by email once the MD has signed.

## Signing for GTIDS

Two people sign for GTIDS, in this order: the designated **employee** for that bank, then the **Managing Director**. Both work the same way, from the **Your actions** panel on the agreement's page.

| You are | Your button | What happens |
|---|---|---|
| The GTIDS employee | **Sign for GTIDS** | The agreement moves to the MD |
| The Managing Director | **Sign as Managing Director** | The agreement completes |

Press it, then **Continue to eSign provider**, authenticate with an Aadhaar OTP, and return to the portal and refresh.

Read the document first. The signature panel shows how many signatures are already on it and whether all are valid — an earlier signature staying valid as later ones are appended is the point of the design, so a signature reported invalid is worth stopping for.

**If the panel is empty, nothing is waiting on you.** It shows only what you may actually do right now. The MD's button does not exist until the employee has signed, and the employee's does not exist until the agent has.

There is no separate approve button. The signature *is* the approval.

On completion the portal emails the agent, the employee, the MD and accounts, each with the executed document attached. Dispatch runs on a schedule rather than instantly, so allow a minute.

### If something is wrong with the document

You can reject it while it is waiting on you — and only while it is waiting on you. Once you have signed, it is the next signer's call. The three options are not interchangeable:

| Action | What it does | When |
|---|---|---|
| **Reject** | Sends it back with a reason, recorded permanently and emailed to the earlier parties. At least 10 characters — "no" will not be accepted. | The content is wrong and should be fixed |

| Action | What it does | When |
|---|---|---|
| **Correct and re-issue** | Reopens the agreement for amendment | Agreed corrections, before completion |
| **Cancel agreement** | Final. Cannot be corrected afterwards, and the stamp paper returns to inventory | The agreement is being abandoned |

Nothing can be edited after completion. A completed agreement is closed to content changes, by the database rather than by the screen hiding a button.

## The two reference numbers

Every agreement carries an **agreement number** from the moment it is created. Once it is fully signed it also gets an **execution reference**. They answer different questions, and neither replaces the other.

| | Agreement number | Execution reference |
|---|---|---|
| Looks like | `GTIDS/2026-27/SVCAGR/000025` | `UBI/AG0042/2026-27/003` |
| Exists from | Creation | Completion — blank until then |
| Tells you | Which agreement this is in the whole register | Which of **that agent's** agreements it is |
| Reads as | GTIDS, financial year, agreement type, serial | Bank, agent, financial year, that agent's serial |

So `UBI/AG0042/2026-27/003` is the third agreement agent AG0042 completed at Union Bank in 2026-27. An agent keeps their code for life, even if they move to another bank, because it identifies the person rather than where they work.

Both appear on the agreement's own page, and the execution reference is included in the completion email sent to each party.

### Looking one up

The search box on **Agreements** accepts any of three things:

- A **full execution reference** — returns that one agreement.
- An **agent code** alone, such as `AG0042` — returns everything that agent has executed. This is usually the one you want.

- An **agreement number**, whole or part.

### What the counterparty sees

The execution reference is **internal**. It is not shown on the public verification page, because it names the bank and the agent, and anyone can open a verification link. The public page confirms only that the agreement exists, is complete and is unaltered.

If you need to give someone outside GTIDS a way to check an agreement, send them the **verification link**, not the reference.

## Checking a completed agreement

Two independent checks, and they answer different questions.

**The audit trail**, on the agreement's own page, shows every event in order with who did it and when, and reports whether the chain is intact. It is not a log that can be tidied up: each record is hash-chained to the one before it, computed by the database, and the portal recomputes them when you look. If a record were altered or removed by anyone — including someone with database access — this is what would show it.

**Public verification** is for the counterparty. Each completed agreement carries a QR code and a verification link that anyone can open without signing in. It confirms the agreement exists, is complete, and that its document is unaltered — and deliberately reveals nothing else: no party names, no email addresses, no document contents. The agreement number cannot be used to browse the register either, so holding one link tells you nothing about any other agreement.

Open the executed PDF in Adobe Acrobat Reader at least once during testing. All three signatures should appear in its signature panel as valid. That is an independent confirmation from software with no connection to this system, which is worth more than the portal agreeing with itself.

## Acceptance test script

Work through these in order with a real bank agreement, a real stamp paper, and a real agent account. Tests 1–9 are the normal path; 10–16 check that the system refuses what it should, which is the half that matters.

| # | Do this | Expected result | Pass |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | As an administrator, add a bank | Listed, and flagged as not ready for use | |

| # | Do this | Expected result | Pass |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | Designate its GTIDS countersigner | Only internal Employee-role staff offered | |
| 3 | Upload the bank's agreement document | Version 1 active; **check the page count** | |
| 4 | Create an agent account attached to that bank | Agent can sign in | |
| 5 | Register the e-Stamp (issuer's PDF) | Green notice; all three identifiers exact; ₹100 | |
| 6 | As the agent, create an agreement | Numbered, in Draft; employee attached automatically | |
| 7 | Allocate the stamp, then compose | 2+ pages, stamp first, no file picker offered | |
| 8 | Sign as Agent | Status becomes *Awaiting GTIDS signature* | |
| 9 | Sign as the employee, then as the MD | Status becomes *Completed* | |
| 10 | Register the same stamp again | **Refused** — try each identifier separately | |
| 11 | As the agent, try to sign as MD or employee | **No such button exists** | |
| 12 | As the MD, try to sign before the employee has | **No such button exists** | |
| 13 | As an agent, open /banks directly | **Refused** — no administration shown | |
| 14 | Reject with the reason "no" | **Refused** — at least 10 characters | |
| 15 | Open the completed PDF in Adobe Acrobat Reader | **Three** signatures, all valid | |
| 16 | Open the public verification link, signed out | Confirms validity; no names, emails or content | |

The three worth spending time on:

**Test 10.** Run it three times, once per identifier, changing the spacing and case each time. All three attempts should be refused. This is what stops one ₹100 stamp being used on two agreements.

**Test 11 and 12.** The ordering is the core control. A button that appears when it should not is a far more serious finding than anything cosmetic.

**Test 7.** Confirm the composed document really is your bank's agreement, and that the agent was given no way to substitute another file.

Also run a **scanned or photographed** copy of the same certificate through test 5, after the PDF. The notice should turn amber and the values may well come back wrong — that is the OCR path, and knowing how badly it degrades on your scanner is worth establishing now rather than in use.

## When something goes wrong

| What you see | What it means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| Certificate warning in the browser | The placeholder certificate, expected on this POC | Continue past it |
| Site does not load at all | Your machine cannot resolve the address | Ask IT for an internal DNS entry |
| Signed in, then bounced back to sign-in | The 30-minute session expired | Sign in again |
| *No GTIDS employee signer is designated for …* | That bank's setup is unfinished | An administrator sets the countersigner |
| *No agreement document is active for …* | That bank has no uploaded agreement | An administrator uploads one |
| *You may only create agreements for your own bank* | You are attached to a different bank | Correct, or ask an administrator |
| *Its text comes from the bank's agreement document* | You tried to upload for a bank agreement | Use **Compose the agreement** instead |
| No stamps in *Available stamps* | None registered, or all claimed | An administrator registers one |
| Compose button disabled | No stamp allocated yet | Allocate the stamp first |
| *Refused — duplicate* on registering a stamp | This stamp is already in the system | Use a different paper. Do not work around it |
| Nothing in *Your actions* | Nothing is waiting on you | Check the status and who acted last |

| What you see | What it means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| Values in the confirmation panel look wrong | OCR misread the scan | Open *Show the raw text that was read*, correct by hand |

If a page returns an error, it will show a short reference code. Send that code to IT rather than a screenshot of the message — it locates the exact request in the server log, which a screenshot cannot.

Do not work around a refusal. Every one of them is enforced deliberately, and the duplicate-stamp check in particular exists to stop one ₹100 paper being used twice. If a refusal looks wrong, it is worth investigating rather than circumventing.

## What is not ready yet

This is a proof of concept. Five things are deliberately incomplete, and knowing which they are keeps testing honest.

**The signatures are not legally valid.** The eSign provider is a stand-in. The ceremony behaves correctly and the resulting PDF signatures verify in Acrobat, but they are not issued by a CCA-licensed provider, so **nothing executed during testing is a binding agreement**. Contracting the provider takes two to four weeks and is the critical path to going live — the system refuses to start in production mode until it is done.

**DigiLocker is not connected.** Aadhaar and PAN are not fetched for identity verification yet; that needs its own registration, separate from eSign. Worth knowing that DigiLocker cannot sign anything — it stores documents. eSign signs.

**There is no multi-factor authentication.** Accounts, including administrators, are protected by a password alone. Acceptable for a test on an internal network; not for live use.

**Documents are on local disk, not the NAS.** They are outside the normal backup policy until the storage mount is scheduled. Treat anything created during testing as disposable.

**An open legal question.** The e-Stamp prints *"Please write or type below this line"* with most of the sheet blank, which is how a stamp paper is conventionally used — the agreement printed onto it. This system instead places the stamp as page 1 with the agreement after. Whether that satisfies the Stamp Act for GTIDS's purposes is a question for legal, and far cheaper to answer now than after agreements are executed for real.

Testing is still worth doing on all of it. What you are confirming is that the workflow, the bank controls and the document handling behave correctly — not that the output can be relied on yet.